



Above The towers of Puebla's colonial cathedral overlook the main plaza, the Zócalo, which was built as a marketplace in 1531



Above Mole poblano de guajolote (turkey) is a variation that often crops up during Puebla's Festival de Mole Poblano, held every July

A Day in Puebla

Puebla is rich in art, architectural, and archaeological interest. The best shopping opportunities arise on a Saturday or Sunday.

MORNING After a hearty breakfast of *huevos rancheros* (spicy eggs with tortillas), head for the antique and flea market in **Callejón de los Sapos** ("The Side Street of the Frogs") to browse for quirky bargains. Drop in to the nearby artists' district of **Barrio del Artista** to buy an original piece from one of the residents, or some of the city's famous blue-and-white pottery, known as *talavera*.

AFTERNOON Visit **Cholula**, 10 miles (16 km) east of Puebla. This is an ancient Indian town (Puebla was wholly built by the Spanish) dating back to the earliest civilizations of Mexico. Climb the huge **pyramid** and catch your breath at the **Iglesia de los Remedios** church atop it to enjoy sweeping views of neighboring volcanoes. Try a cup of *popo*, made of rice, cocoa, and chupipi fruit, on your way down, then explore the tunnels, crypts, and tombs beneath the pyramid.

EVENING After all that activity, you'll have earned a quiet supper.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Puebla is 80 miles (125 km) from Mexico City, around two hours' drive from the capital along a good highway via **rental car** or **bus/coach**. Its small **airport** receives international flights from Houston, TX, and domestic arrivals from Cancún.

WHERE TO STAY

Hotel Colonial (inexpensive) is a friendly B&B near the main square. www.colonial.com.mx

Camino Real (moderate) is a beautifully restored convent in the city's historic center. www.caminoreal.com/puebla

La Purificadora (expensive), formerly a water purification factory, has been transformed by an architect into a contemporary design hotel – the pool is amazing. www.lapurificadora.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.visitmexico.com